LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH JUNIOR (K–2) ADVANCED: GAME BUILDERS

Lesson 7: Send a Message ✉️

Module 3 | 30 minutes | Messages (communication between characters) | KG–Grade 2 · ages 6–7

Objective: Explain how one character can send a message that starts another character's script, and plan a relay.

Success criteria

- I can explain what a message does.
- I can plan a relay with messages.
- I can fix mismatched colours.

Key vocabulary

- **message**: A signal sent from one character to another.
- **send**: Pass the message on.
- **relay**: A race where team members take turns.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

Timed lesson plan (30 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Pass the message (5 min): a line of children passing a tap.
5 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question.
8 min	**Build along**	A relay race in ScratchJr: learners follow the steps.
5 min	**Perform**	First runner, Relay order, Message bug
3 min	**Probe**	Second runner, Pass it on
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket: What must match for a message to work?

Unplugged warm-up

Pass the message (5 min): a line of children passing a tap.

Teaching the idea

Messages (broadcasts) coordinate characters: a send block triggers matching "start on message" scripts. Colour-matched channels in ScratchJr.

Analogy: A relay baton: you can't run until you get it.

Live demo: Show matching and mismatched message colours.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
When does the turtle start?	When it gets the message.
Why didn't it start?	Colours didn't match.
Who sends the message?	The first runner.

Differentiation

Support
Pre-build the rabbit; children build the turtle.

Stretch
A three-runner relay with two message colours.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Messages go to one character only	Every character waiting for that colour starts.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

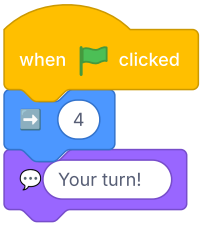
Exit ticket
What must match for a message to work?

Homework
Play a relay game at home.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. First runner (perform · block code)

One solution:



2. Relay order (perform · ordering)

Order: 🏁 Rabbit starts on the green flag → 🐰 Rabbit runs → ✉️ Rabbit sends a message → 📬 Turtle gets the message → 🐢 Turtle runs

3. Message bug (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: The colours don't match

4. Second runner (probe · block code)

One solution:



5. Pass it on (probe · speaking)

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** message = A signal sent from one character to another. · send = Pass the message on. · relay = A race where team members take turns.
2. **Relay order:** 1 🏁 Rabbit starts on the green flag · 2 🐰 Rabbit runs · 3 ✉️ Rabbit sends a message · 4 📬 Turtle gets the message · 5 🐢 Turtle runs
3. **Message bug:** A. The colours don't match — Messages only start scripts waiting for the same colour.
4. **Draw the relay:** Runner 1 → ✉️ → runner 2.

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.